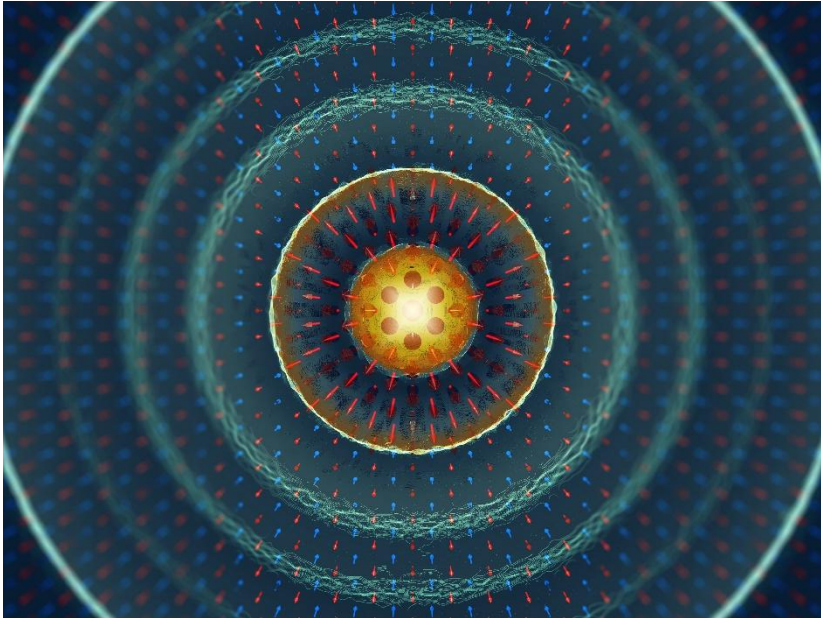




Arrival Booklet

International Max Planck Research School for
Ultrafast Imaging & Structural Dynamics

Dear new IMPRS member,

Welcome to Hamburg and to the IMPRS UFAST community!

The IMPRS UFAST brings together fellows from more than 20 different countries.

This booklet is meant to serve you as reference guide for the first weeks of your doctoral studies and new life in Hamburg. It contains information on important administrative steps, introduces some of the key structures of the IMPRS, and provides miscellaneous practical information.

We are very much looking forward to getting to know and to working with you. The academic and social network of the IMPRS is a work in progress and we hope that you will help us to continually grow and ensure the quality of the programme.

Please bear in mind that we are here to support you, so do not hesitate to contact us!

We hope that the time you spend with us will prove to be both academically challenging and personally satisfying for you.

IMPRS UFAST office

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Neda", is positioned below the text "IMPRS UFAST office".

Dr. Neda Lotfiomran



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Important things to do on arrival

A checklist can be found at the end of this booklet

Accommodation

Hamburg is a beautiful city, but unfortunately, it is not easy to find suitable, affordable housing here in time for the start of the semester (winter semester starts in October and summer semester starts in April). Expect it to take some time to find an apartment or room. At the beginning, it helps if you make some compromises. After you become familiar with Hamburg, it will be easier to find an apartment.

DESY Housing Service

The [DESY Housing Service](#) helps for all members of the DESY campus community their search for long-term (more than 4 weeks) accommodation. To request assistance in your search, please complete the online form of the Housing Service: <https://welcome-services.desy.de/>

Finding your own room, apartment or shared housing

Enter the search words “WG Hamburg” (housing share Hamburg) or “Hamburg Wohngemeinschaften” (Hamburg housing shares) in an online search engine for a list of links to online housing exchanges. Alternatively, enter “Kleinanzeigen Hamburg” (classified ads Hamburg) for links to classified ads for private housing.

Useful links for housing search:

www.studierendenwerk-hamburg.de

→ Accommodation → Private Rooms:

www.wg-gesucht.de/en/

Lets and rooms in private accommodation

Costs you have to cover for you accommodation:

Expect incidental expenses (Nebenkosten) in addition to basic rent (Kaltmiete). The landlord receives the Warmmiete, meaning basic rent plus a few incidentals; for other incidentals, one apartment resident needs to sign a contract with the provider. Below is a list of possible incidentals:

- running costs (such as garbage collection and janitorial services; these are included in rent)
- heating (may be included in rent or may be payable directly to gas provider)
- electricity (resident signs contract independently with provider)
- gas (for stove or oven; resident signs contract independently with provider)
- state TV and radio license fees (mandatory fees for every apartment: 18,36€ /month)

Please note that in a WG, one person pays the rent, electricity, Internet, TV and radio license fee; the other residents give this person their respective shares. To avoid conflict, agreements should be put in writing before everyone moves in (at least per email).

Security deposit

Landlords may request up to three months of rent (Kaltmiete) as a security deposit. Providing that there are no damages, you get the security deposit back after you move out. The DESY Housing Office offers advice on rental agreements, please contact them for an appointment if required.

Residential registration and immigration issues

In Germany, people (independent of their nationality!) have to register their address with the relevant registration office

(Einwohnermeldeamt) within two weeks of moving into their accommodation in Hamburg. Booking an appointment alone does not constitute registration. You must also register any family members who may be accompanying you. You will need a registration certificate (which you receive when you register) to open a bank account, extend your visa, use the libraries, obtain health insurance and conclude agreements (e.g. for a cell phone).

Register your address

Please register your residential (or preliminary) address with the Einwohnermeldeamt in Hamburg. You will normally need your passport or identity card and a landlord's confirmation of residence (Wohnungsgeberbestätigung). Depending on your eligibility, you can use the [electronic residence registration service](#) or [make an appointment with Hamburg Service](#).

Residence permit (Aufenthaltstitel)

Depending on your nationality, the purpose and duration of your stay, and your individual circumstances, you may need a residence permit for Germany. The type and validity of the permit depend on your individual situation. The DESY International Office provides advice and support on residence-related matters and can help you prepare the required documents and forms. Where possible, the International Office can also assist with arranging appointments with the Hamburg Welcome Center.

We strongly recommend contacting the DESY International Office after your arrival in Hamburg to clarify any residence-related requirements

DESY International Office (Building 6)

http://guest-services.desy.de/international_office/

Hamburg Welcome Center

https://welcome.hamburg.com/contact-us?utm_source=chatgpt.com

Süderstraße 32b, 20097 Hamburg

Phone: **+49 40 42839-5555**.

Email: info@welcome.hamburg.de

Opening a bank account

You can open a bank account at a bank in Hamburg. An everyday bank account in Germany is called a “Girokonto”. It allows you to receive your salary, transfer money, withdraw cash at an ATM, and pay for goods and services by card.

There are various banks and account options available in Hamburg. We recommend comparing the available options and checking which account best meets your individual needs. Please also check the current fees and conditions directly with the bank.

To open a bank account the following documents are usually required:

- Meldebescheinigung (registration certificate)
- Passport or identity card
- Student identification: confirmation of admission to doctoral proceedings or enrolment certificate as a doctoral student (optional and only if applicable)
- A proof of income makes the opening of a bank account easier (pay slip, bank statement, signed work contract)

Health Insurance

Health insurance coverage is mandatory for everybody residing in Germany. As an employee, you are generally covered by statutory health insurance (Gesetzliche Krankenversicherung, GKV). The contribution consists of a general contribution rate plus an additional contribution set by the individual health insurance provider. The contributions are

generally shared equally between the employer and the employee and are automatically deducted from your monthly salary. Once you have registered with a health insurance provider, please make sure that the required proof of insurance is available to your employer.

A list of all state and private health insurance providers in Germany can be found here: www.krankenkassen.de

Required documents for the application:

- Passport or identity card
- Registration certificate
- Statement of income
- Bank account details

Personal liability insurance (Haftpflichtversicherung)

Personal liability insurance (Haftpflichtversicherung) is not mandatory in Germany, but it is highly recommended. It can cover claims for damages that you unintentionally cause to other people or their property. Before taking out a policy, check carefully which situations and persons are covered by the insurance.

Work contract

The IMPRS UFAST is a collaborative enterprise of the Max Planck Institute for the Structure and Dynamics of Matter (MPSD), the University of Hamburg (UHH), Deutsches Elektronen-Synchrotron (DESY), and European XFEL.

The financing for a particular PhD position is provided by the institution of the relevant supervisor and comes in form of a PhD contract.

Depending on your financing institution, you may have already received a sample of your work contract or the necessary preparatory steps for employment have been taken prior to arrival. In most cases work contracts are only signed upon arrival in Hamburg.

If you have not already signed your contract, please contact your group administrator/ secretary upon arrival in Hamburg. He/ She can give

advice on the necessary steps and contacts. Make sure you know if you have to bring any documents.

Typical documents you will need to show are:

- details of a German bank account
- German address
- your passport
- original Master degree certificate and Master transcript
- confirmation of health insurance

Guest Contract

If you have a working contract with Hamburg University, DESY or European XFEL, you will receive a guest contract from MPSD.

For all questions regarding employment contracts, personnel matters, onboarding documents, health and social insurance related to your employment, parental leave, and other HR-related matters, please contact the MPSD Human Resources Department.

Contact:

Human Resource Department

Kathja Schroeder

Head of Personnel Department

Tel: +49 (0)40 8998-88020

Email: kathja.schroeder@mpsd.mpg.de

Room: 99/O1.095

Charlotte Burrows

Personnel

Tel: +49 (0)40 8998-88021

Email: charlotte.burrows@mpsd.mpg.de

Room: 99/O1.097

Sandra Wieler

Personnel

Tel: +49 (0)40 8998-88022

Email: sandra.wieler@mpsd.mpg.de

Room: 99/O1.099

General HR contact: personal@mpsd.mpg.de

Studies

With signing your contract or scholarship agreement, you are accepted for a PhD position within IMPRS UFAST. In addition, you must apply for admission to doctoral studies at the relevant department of the Faculty of Mathematics, Informatics and Natural Sciences (MIN Faculty), usually Physics or Chemistry, and subsequently enrol as a doctoral student at Universität Hamburg. This is done in two separate steps: (1) admission to doctoral studies and (2) enrolment at Universität Hamburg.

Step 1: Admission as a doctoral candidate

- Apply online at [Docata](#)-MIN
- We recommend using an email address that you check regularly throughout your doctoral studies.
- Send the documents listed below to the Office of Academic Affairs (“Studienbüro”) of your corresponding department (Please note that they only process applications for admission ELECTRONICALLY).

Documents you will need to apply as a doctoral candidate

- Application for admission to doctoral procedures, generated through Docata-MIN and completed with all required signatures. Scanned and electronic signatures are accepted.
- Completed and fully signed research project outline (“Forschungsskizze”); please use the current official form.
- Curriculum Vitae
- Publication list

- Diploma of university degrees (copy, officially exemplified): Bachelor and Master
- Transcript of Records (copy, officially exemplified): Bachelor and Master
- A copy of your university entrance certification
- A copy of your passport/ID card
- **Only for international students:** Master thesis on electronic disk: if not in German/English, include an abstract of 1-2 pages in German or English
- Graduate School membership form
- Supervision Agreement (the IMPRS office will provide you with it)
- **For applications to the Department of Chemistry:** If your degree was obtained outside Germany, the degree documents should be submitted electronically to the Chemistry Doctoral Office in advance.
- **For applications to the Department of Physics:** If your Master's degree was obtained outside Germany, was not obtained in Physics, or was awarded by a University of Applied Sciences (Fachhochschule), please contact the Physics Doctoral Office for a preliminary review of the admission requirements before submitting your application.
- For Physics and Chemistry, the fully signed application and the remaining application documents must currently be combined into ONE PDF file (maximum size 30 MB) and submitted through Docata-MIN. Please always follow the current instructions of the relevant department.
- For current deadlines and requirements, please always check the information provided by Universität Hamburg and the relevant doctoral office. For Chemistry, the application must normally be submitted no later than three months after the start of the doctoral project.

The IMPRS office will provide you with all required forms. You can also find all forms and more details of the doctoral procedures for the Department of Physics ([here](#)) and for the Department of Chemistry ([here](#))

Contact Persons

Studienbüro Physik:

E-Mail: promotion.phys@uni-hamburg.de.

Thomas Weiler:

- Raum 028
- Telefon **+49 40 2395-27031**

Theresa Kertz ergänzen:

- Raum 029
- Telefon **+49 40 2395-26437**

Head of the doctoral office:

Irmgard Flick:

- Telefon **+49 40 2395-24057**
- E-Mail irmgard.flick@uni-hamburg.de

Studienbüro Chemie:

Advisory Service:

Uta Fischer

E-Mail: promotion@chemie.uni-hamburg.de

Uta Fischer

Grindelallee 117, Raum: 50,

20146 Hamburg

Tel.: +49 40 42838-2511

E-Mail: uta.fischer@chemie.uni-hamburg.de

Official supervision agreement for your application at UHH

The doctoral regulations of the MIN faculty give you the option to formally register supervisors as follows:

1. You can opt to register one supervisor only, which will usually be your main IMPRS supervisor.
2. You can opt to register a supervisor and a co-advisor. Both advisors must also be the scientists serving on your IMPRS Advisory Panel.
3. You can choose to register an Advisory Panel consisting of a supervisor, a co-advisor, and a panel chair. All three must be the scientists serving on your IMPRS Advisory Panel.

Please note that the supervisors registered at this stage will not necessarily all be the reviewers of your dissertation or part of your exam committee. You will be asked to suggest reviewers for your dissertation and your examination commission as you get ready to hand in your thesis for evaluation.

Step 2: Enrolment at the University of Hamburg

Once you have been admitted to doctoral studies by the relevant department, you can apply for enrolment as a doctoral student at Universität Hamburg. Please note that specific deadlines apply and that the enrolment process may take several weeks.

- Submit the application in the online application portal STiNE: www.uni-hamburg.de/online-bewerbung
- Finally, hand in the documents listed below to the Campus Center

Campus Center
Team Bewerbung und Zulassung
Alsterterrasse 1
20354 Hamburg
Tel.: (040) 42838-7000



<https://www.uni-hamburg.de/en/campuscenter.html>

Required documents for enrolment at Hamburg University

- Printed application form from the online application in STiNE
- The confirmation of admission or a notification from the Studienbüro
- Diploma of university degree (officially exemplified)
- Confirmation of your supervisor
- Health insurance confirmation

Upon successful matriculation you will receive a preliminary confirmation of enrolment and instructions on how to pay your semester fee.

Student ID card and Semester Ticket

Once the semester fee is paid, you will receive your digital student ID in STiNE and your digital Deutschlandsemesterticket through the ticket portal linked by Hamburg University. The ticket is valid throughout Germany on local public transport and regional trains for one semester. The Deutschlandsemesterticket is personal and non-transferable. It does not include the standard free transportation of accompanying adults or children aged 6 to 14. Children under the age of 6 always travel free of charge on hvv services. As of 1st April 2024, eligible students receive the Deutschlandsemesterticket.

STiNE (Studieninfonetz)

[STiNE](#) is the University of Hamburg's campus management system and an important online platform for organising various aspects of your studies. Important features include:

- course catalogue and course schedules
- Registration for courses and examinations, where applicable
- study documents (e.g. proof of enrolment)
- important information regarding re-enrolment and payment of the semester contribution



Access to STiNE is available after the enrolment process has been completed. After your enrolment application has been processed, Universität Hamburg will provide you with your new login details by email. You will also receive a TAN list, which is required for certain functions in STiNE.

IMPRS UFAST Training opportunities (Curricula)

The IMPRS UFAST curriculum consists of various components and is an integral part of PhD studies within the IMPRS whilst you will be asked to complete a certain amount of academic and skills training courses during your time as IMPRS fellow. For detailed information, please refer to our official [Curriculum Guidelines](#). The curriculum of each semester will be announced at the beginning of the semester. The entire program is listed on [IMPRS website](#) and Geventis.

Geventis

[Geventis](#) is the webbased tool used for booking your IMPRS UFAST courses and keeping an overview of your attended courses. You can enroll for Geventis with your Docata username and password.



Workspace

As a PhD student your research group will provide you with a workspace (office, desk and computer). All arrangements will be made by the group administration/ secretary and you should contact the relevant colleague upon arrival.

Living in Hamburg



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Port of Hamburg and the Landungsbrücken in St. Pauli quarter

Public transportation

The **HVV (Hamburger Verkehrsverbund)** is the public transport provider for Hamburg City and region. The network is well developed and it is easy to travel around by metro (S-Bahn/ U-Bahn) or bus.

Most S-bahn services run until late at night or even throughout the night at regular intervals. Buses run late or are replaced by night buses with limited service between certain hours. Tickets/ fares are reasonable and day and group tickets are available.

The [HVV website](#) is a great resource to find out which network transportation is available in a certain area of the city and how to get from A to Z.

StadtRAD

Hamburg is a bike-friendly city and you may recognize that buying a bike may be a convenient way for you to get around.

If you don't want to buy a bike, maybe StadtRAD could be a preferable option for you. These

are bikes of a bicycle rental system offered by Deutsche Bahn in collaboration with the city of Hamburg. To use these bikes, you will need to register and create an account. For registration you will need a permanent address and a banking card of a German bank account. Once your account is set up you can pick up and return a bike at any StadtRAD station in the city. The first 30 minutes are free, after that you will be charged a price per minute of use.



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Sports

Hamburg University offers a wide range of courses for staff and students at low cost. [Here](#) you can find more information.

Health care

If you become ill, you can directly go to a doctor's surgery. In order to get specialist treatment, including dental treatment, you can directly make an appointment with a relevant surgery. You can search for general practitioners, specialists or pharmacies online. A list of doctors, including information on their language skills) can be found [here](#).

If you are with a public health insurance provider, you will be issued with a Health Insurance Card (Gesundheitskarte) which you always need to carry with you. Please present this card when you go to a doctor's surgery. The surgery will be able to reconcile treatment costs directly with the insurance provider. For any treatment received and which is not covered by the insurance, you will receive an invoice.

Culture

If you are interested in culture and arts, there are many possibilities like renowned museums and theatres in Hamburg. For further information, you may follow the [link](#) and/ or ask the IMPRS office for advice.

My Notes

Checklist for new IMPRS fellows

- ☐ Sign your contract
- ☐ Arrive and visit the IMPRS office
- ☐ Get an official e-mail-address at your institute
- ☐ Get an MPSD E-mail-address (If your employer is not MPS)
- ☐ Registration at the residence registration office with
- ☐ current address
- ☐ Residence permit, if required
- ☐ Health Insurance (mandatory)
- ☐ Open a bank account, if required for salary payments

- ☐ Application for admission as doctoral student via Docata
- ☐ Matriculation (registration as student)